Case Study: UPI / Online Payment Fraud

UPI/Online Payment Fraud is a type of cybercrime where attackers trick people into sending money or revealing sensitive banking details. It has become very common in India due to the increasing use of digital payment apps.

A typical case happens in a few simple steps. First, the fraudster contacts the victim through a call, message, or social media, pretending to be a bank official, customer care executive, or even a buyer/seller. Next, they create urgency by saying there is a problem with the account, a pending refund, or an attractive offer. Then, they send a fake payment link or request, or ask the victim to scan a QR code. Many people do not realize that scanning a QR code or approving a request can actually send money instead of receiving it. Finally, once the victim enters their UPI PIN or approves the transaction, the money gets transferred to the scammer's account instantly.

Students, elderly people, and those who are new to digital payments are usually targeted because they may not be fully aware of such tricks.

The consequences can be serious. Victims may lose their money within seconds, and it is often difficult to recover it. It can also lead to stress, fear, and loss of trust in online systems. This shows the importance of being careful while using digital payment platforms.